

# Run Linux on Windows

One of the many reasons to run Linux on Windows would be to get the best of both worlds. There are several methods for running Linux on Windows. The authors recommend Linux Integration Services, which has been made available by Microsoft. Read on to learn how to use LIS.



Recent releases from Microsoft—‘Windows Server 2012 R2’ and ‘System Centre 2012 R2’—comes with the ability to effectively host Linux and associated open source applications, along with great management capabilities. Some of the improvements in Windows Server 2012 R2 include faster live migration, dynamic memory support that can be used depending on workload, as well as the capability to dynamically resize VHDs and VHDXs. On the other hand, System Centre provides a single interface for managing Windows, ESXi and Linux operating systems. Microsoft’s new feature from Windows Server 2012 R2 and System Centre 2012 R2 called Data Centre Abstraction Layer (DAL), based on CIM and WS-Man standards,

has common management abstracts for managing all the resources of a data centre (this includes the physical and virtual environments). To support DAL, Microsoft has contributed Open Management Infrastructure (OMI) along with other providers to effectively manage Linux. OMI is well known for its smaller disk footprint.

This article will tell you how to use Windows Server 2012 R2 Hyper-V and Windows Hyper-V Server 2012 R2, and why installing Linux Integration Services is a best practice while running Linux as a guest OS.

## Different ways of running Linux on Windows

Linux can be run on Windows in the following ways.